

Foot Pain - Male (Child)

Algorithm 1501 | Child (0-17 years) | Gender at birth: Male

Definition

- UAT-only adult and pediatric non-traumatic foot-pain pathway screening for infection, inability to bear weight, neurovascular compromise and diabetic or immune risk before in-person assessment.
- Child patient.
- Male.

Initial assessment

1. [LOCATION] Where exactly is the pain?
2. [DURATION] How long has the pain lasted?
3. [YES_NO] Is the skin around the foot swollen and hot?
4. [OPEN_TEXT] What is the age; is there diabetes/neuropathy, immune/vascular disease, wound/foreign body, inability to bear weight, pregnancy/postpartum status, hidden trauma, neurovascular change or child safeguarding concern?
5. [CAREGIVER_OBSERVATION] What has a safe parent or caregiver observed about alertness, breathing, pain, swelling, fever, eating or drinking, sleep, play, and normal activity?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Motor Vehicle Accident

Did this joint problem begin with a motor vehicle crash or as part of a multi-system crash injury?

A motor vehicle crash or multi-system crash injury belongs in the Motor Vehicle Accident pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Is foot pain severe with inability to bear weight or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot, or is there a diabetic/other wound or hot swelling plus marked systemic illness or rapid deterioration?

NHS.UK joint pain guidance lists swelling/heat and feeling unwell as reasons for urgent review; diabetic foot problems specifically need prompt assessment given the higher risk of complications.

1. Disposition level 70

With no emergency feature, is there any persistent or unexplained foot pain, wound, swelling, walking limitation, diabetes/immune risk, child concern or higher-risk context?

In-person assessment is required, particularly for diabetes/neuropathy, wounds, immune risk, children and impaired weight bearing.

Advice

Qatar emergency foot response

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for systemic illness with hot swelling, inability to bear weight, severe rapidly worsening pain, or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot. Do not allow self-driving. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: increasing swelling or redness; fever or neurovascular change.

In-person foot assessment

- Arrange in-person assessment, especially for a child, pregnancy, diabetes, neuropathy, immune compromise or skin break. Protect from pressure and do not use fixed-dose analgesia until patient factors are checked.
- Call Back If: pain persists or worsens; swelling, redness or fever.

First aid

- Call Qatar emergency services on 999 for systemic illness with hot swelling, inability to bear weight, severe rapidly worsening pain, or a cold/pale/blue/numb foot. Do not allow self-driving. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Joint pain", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/joint-pain/> (page last reviewed 26 February 2026) - applied to non-traumatic foot pain

Provenance

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